Data quality and governance plan

DAT 325 Project One | Academic coursework | Acquisition integration planning

An academic plan for evaluating and improving an acquired firm's data before it enters existing systems. The report links quality checks with ownership, access controls and documented decision making.

Purpose

Reduce preventable reporting errors and repeated corrections by defining quality expectations before integration. The intended outcome is trustworthy combined data, supported by consistent definitions and accountable owners.

Quality framework

The plan addresses accuracy, completeness, consistency, validity, timeliness and uniqueness. It places particular attention on inconsistent formats, invalid values and duplicate identities across two organizations.

Proposed workflow

- Profile the acquired data for missing values, invalid entries, inconsistent formats, outdated information and duplicates.
- Define standard formats and business rules; then clean and transform against those standards.
- Verify sources and identity matches, align units and definitions, and resolve duplicate records.
- Validate changes against the rules and source information. Document transformations and monitor quality after integration.

Governance responsibilities

Data owners approve important rules and are accountable for their domains. Data stewards monitor standards and quality. IT and security teams manage access and technical controls. Legal and compliance personnel review applicable requirements.

Scope and evidence

The completed deliverable is a written plan. It identifies excessive access, inconsistent policies, unclear ownership and undocumented transformations as risks. Profiling, cleansing, validation and ongoing monitoring are proposed activities; no executed workflow or measured quality improvement is evidenced.

Skills demonstrated

Data quality frameworks; governance; process design; responsibility mapping.

Source and attribution

Olga Solodovnikova, Project One Data Quality Plan, DAT 325, Southern New Hampshire University, September 20, 2026. The report references Ladley, Omol et al., Redman and Roundy.